

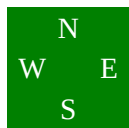
Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ J 8 6
 ♥ Q J 8 7 2
 ♦ 10 9 4
 ♣ 6 3

♠ Q 10 7
 ♥ 10 5
 ♦ Q 7 2
 ♣ A Q 10 9 5



♠ 9 5 4 2
 ♥ A 9 6 3
 ♦ J 8 3
 ♣ K 4

♠ A K 3
 ♥ K 4
 ♦ A K 6 5
 ♣ J 8 7 2

West	North	East	South
			1 ♦
Pass	2 ♣	Pass	3NT
All Pass			

3NT by South

you know that if you lose the lead there will be a deluge of ♥s on the table. ♣s is your best suit, and if the finesse works you will make 6. Of course if it fails you will go down. But there is one thing you should do before you stake everything on a 50% finesse. You should play 3 rounds of ♦s. If they split 3-3 you will have found your ninth trick and you won't risk the ♣ finesse.

If you try the ♣ finesse you will go down, losing 1 ♣ and 4 ♥s. If you take your 4 ♦ tricks and refuse to try the ♣ finesse you will make the contract.

The best thing about this plan is that when you test the ♦s, if it turns out they do not split 3-3 you can still try the ♣ finesse.

You are too strong to open 1NT. With two 4-card minors the correct opening bid is 1 ♦. Partner responds 2 ♣.

You now need to make a jump bid. You **MIGHT** jump to 4 ♣ but that would bypass what is probably your best game. Instead you just jump to 3NT. Partner doesn't **HAVE** to pass, but he does.

South plays 3NT. West leads the ♥7 East wins ♥A and returns ♥9.

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Winner count: ♠ 3 : ♥ 1 : ♦ 3 : ♣ 1 : Total = 8

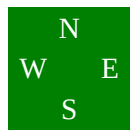
You have a **LOT** of points - but only 8 tricks. And

Board 3

North Deals
None Vul

♠ Q J 9 4
♥ K Q 10 7
♦ J 10 8 2
♣ 9

♠ A 8 5 3
♥ A 6 4 2
♦ K 7
♣ A K 5



♠ K
♥ J 9 8 3
♦ Q 9 5 4 3
♣ 6 4 2

♠ 10 7 6 2
♥ 5
♦ A 6
♣ Q J 10 8 7 3

West	North	East	South
	1 ♣	Pass	1 ♠
Pass	3 ♠	Pass	4 ♠
All Pass			

4 ♠ by South
pull trumps. You win the ♥ A and play the ♠ A. East plays the ♠ K!

Do you change your Plan? Click?

Do you change your **PLAN**?

Well, East may be false-carding. He may also have the ♠ Q for example. But if you decide to play another trump and it turns out he was NOT false-carding you will be dead in the water. West will take his three trump tricks and some ♥s. Many ♥s.

So don't take the chance. Abandon trumps and start playing ♣ winners. Let West take the three trumps whenever he wants to. You will not lose control of the hand and will make your 10 tricks.

The risk of leading a second trump was too great.

As you see, West would have pulled your and dummy's trumps and then won 3 ♥ tricks.

A slightly different Plan would also have worked. At trick two you could have played a low trump from both hands. East would win the ♠ K, then probably play another ♥. You ruff, play a ♠ to the ♠ A and discover the split. From there the Plan is the same, play your ♣s and let West ruff when he wants.

Well, you're pretty sure you have a ♣ fit. But before you show partner your fine ♣ support you have an obligation to show a 4-card Major.

You respond 1 ♠, partner jumps to 3 ♠.

Your hand revalues to 11 or 12 points so you should bid game. 5 ♣ requires 11 tricks and 4 ♠ only 10 tricks. You bid 4 ♠.

South plays 4 ♠. West leads the ♥ K.

South plays 4 ♠. West leads the ♥ K.

Losers: ♠ 2 : ♥ 0 : ♦ 0 : ♣ 0 : Total = 2

You expect trumps to split 3-2 so you would lose 2 trumps. You have no other losers so you decide to